



BERNERA NEWS

A Community Newsletter in association with 

Welcome to the 15th Issue and 1st Anniversary edition of the Bernera News.

Spring is slower to come this year and we're shivering in the colder winds, so we hope you are all well.

We have experienced so much change this year, not least how we connect and communicate as a community, as well as in our families and with friends. Work too has changed with endless online meetings and working across the internet has become the norm for some.

When we started the Bernera News last year, we hoped it would help to keep everyone informed and a little entertained. We set out to ensure no one was excluded from local news, just because social media wasn't their cup of tea.

The first issue focused on information, as we all came to grips with what the pandemic would bring. Alongside this we had early online activity on our Daily Ceilidh website, where we hoped to provide a sense of connection. The good weather last May helped to keep spirits up and many were able to do more at home and in their gardens. Much didn't change for some, but no one can deny the sadness at the passing of members of the community with quieter celebrations of their lives and a lack of gathering over a cup of tea in the Community Hall to reminisce has been a loss. For those shielding, it has been a particularly isolating time and we give thanks to our local doctor's team, our firemen and women, community volunteers and essential workers who carried us through, as well as our neighbours for all their efforts.

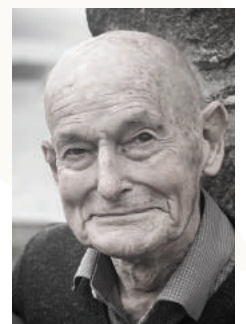
One year on, vaccinations are taking place, restrictions are easing and everyone is talking about getting back to normal. Here at the Bernera News though, we are talking about getting back to special. It's become clear that family get-togethers, missed hugs from grandparents, meals shared, community gathering and chats with friends in our homes aren't just normal, they're special. Without them, it has felt strange. Here's to more special times in all our lives.

With that in mind, an average issue takes the team a total of 3 full days to produce and print. So all the contributions, deliveries and feedback has been special, we could not have done it without you all. We've been able to deliver to just under 150 homes and to include interviews, articles, quizzes, recipes and information from 41 contributors. We have had some small donations from the community, a grant from the Great Bernera Community Development Trust and continue to self fund.

Who knows what lies ahead, but we're certain that the Bernera community will rise to the challenge and help to bring back something special, whether that's a take away from the Cafe, a ceilidh or the return of the bowls sessions.

Dr Hay

We were incredibly saddened to hear of the passing of Dr John Hay of Uigen, on Sunday 9th May. Dr Hay was well known, and much loved and respected within our community. Our thoughts go out to his family at this difficult time, and to all those who had the pleasure of knowing him.



COVID UPDATE

On Monday 17th May, Lewis and Harris moved into Level 1 Coronavirus Restrictions. These allow for a greater freedom, but it is still asked that you act responsibly.

We are now allowed to meet socially in groups:

Of up to 6 people from 3 households in your home or theirs - and can stay overnight

Of up to 8 people from 3 households in an indoor public place like a cafe or restaurant

Of up to 12 people from 12 households outdoors in your garden or a public place

Under 12s do not count towards the total number of people, but do count towards the number of households indoors.

It is also fantastic news that you no longer need to physically distance from family and friends in a private home.

You are also allowed to travel anywhere in Scotland in levels 0, 1 or 2 but must not enter a Level 3 or 4 area unless for a permitted reason. Travel to the rest of the UK is also allowed, but you must check the travel rules in those countries before you travel.

TESTING

To reduce the risk of coronavirus being brought into the island communities by people who are unaware they are infectious, the Scottish Government is encouraging anyone travelling to the islands to test before they do so. This includes islanders who leave in order to visit the mainland. You can order rapid lateral flow tests for delivery to your home anywhere in the UK and they should arrive within 24 - 48 hours. It is recommended that you test 3 days before you plan to return, and then again on the day of departure.

Please note that if your test is negative, this is not a guarantee that you do not have coronavirus. You must continue to follow national and local restrictions, including **FACTS** guidance (*Face covering, avoid crowds, clean hands and surfaces regularly, stay 2 metres from other people*).

Tests can be ordered online at:

<https://test-for-coronavirus.service.gov.uk/order-lateral-flow-kits/condition> or by calling **119**.

EILEAN SIAR FOODBANK

The foodbank is currently short of the following items which help make up our food parcels that go to those who are struggling just now: Baked beans, pasta sauces, Ambrosia rice, Biscuits, and shower gel. If you are able to donate any of these items, or other dried goods, all of which should be within date, they would be greatly appreciated. They are based next door to the Caladh Hotel (white building, formerly the HIE offices) and are open Monday, Wednesday and Fridays between 11am and 1.30pm. There are also food drop off points in the Co-op and Tesco.

DEAF AWARENESS WEEK

Deaf Awareness Week was held earlier this month. People who are deaf, or have a hearing loss, can experience feelings of isolation, so it's extremely important that we do what we can to break down these communication barriers. Simple things that we can all do include:

- Face the person while you are speaking, don't turn away
- Repeat yourself if necessary
- Never say "it doesn't matter"
- Speak one at a time, don't talk over each other
- Don't speak too quickly or too slowly
- Try not to shout, but do try to speak clearly

DOGS

Access and Responsibilities

We have been asked to share the information about the responsibilities of dog ownership in public access places, whether on a road, on common grazing land, or on croft land from the Outdoor Access Scotland publication "Taking the lead".

The guidance relates to dogs accompanied by people on foot or cycle (and include arriving by car and then being walked). Stray, unaccompanied dogs are a different issue, best dealt with by the local authority dog warden.

The Land Reform (Scotland) Act 2003 provides public rights of access to most land and inland water, both day and night, for recreational and educational purposes. Access rights are conditional on responsible behaviour and do not apply to anyone with a dog which is not under proper control. Public access with or without dogs may differ on rights of way.

The Scottish Outdoor Access Code guidance on what is considered responsible behaviour includes:

Not entering a field where there are young livestock, such as lambs and calves.

Where possible, choosing a route that avoids taking their dog through fields with livestock, such as going into a neighbouring field or onto adjacent land.

If going through land where livestock are grazing, or are likely to be grazing, keeping as far as possible from any animals and their dog on a short lead (2 metres) or close at heel.

Keeping their dog on a short lead or close at heel during the breeding season (usually April to July) in areas where there are likely to be ground nesting birds, such as moorland, loch shores and the seashore.

Ensuring that their dog does not worry or attack livestock.

Confusion about walking on public roads through areas of unfenced grazing is perhaps understandable. But the same rules apply to all public access.

Your dog should always be under control.

You should never allow your dog to worry livestock. This includes chasing, barking and biting, no matter how "playful" it may appear.

Dog Fouling

This continues to be a problem. During the recent Community Clean Up it became apparent that some areas have a serious problem. Under the Dog Fouling (Scotland) Act 2003 you are guilty of an offence if you fail to remove your dog's faeces from a public place and dispose of it properly. This includes areas such as verges and pathways, as well as beaches.

Dog waste can carry potentially dangerous diseases which, although rare, can cause severe problems to human health. Parasites found in some dog faeces can also result in the abortions of cattle and death in sheep. NFU Scotland therefore urges members of the public to also clean up after their dogs when walking in places where these animals are present, including on croft land and common grazings.

Discarded waste-filled bags also carry a significant threat to livestock and other wildlife, so please ensure that any collected waste is disposed of responsibly. You can use any public litter bin, not just designated dog waste bins, otherwise you should dispose of it in your own general waste bins at home. Should you witness someone failing to clean up after their dog and you know the owner's details, the Comhairle asks that you report it to them. **(01851) 822694**

RISE TO THE CHALLENGE AND GET GROWING

Everyone is invited to take part in our Bernera Sunflower Growing Competition.

We've included 2 seeds per household on every copy of the **BN**. We want big and tall sunflowers to brighten up our year and hope you can join in.

Get planting now and you will have until 30 September 2021 to submit your photo and height in cm of your sunflower, and we will announce a winner in the October edition of the **Bernera News**.

Send your photos and final height measurement (in cm) to hello@thedailyceilidh.co.uk, along with your name and contact details and tell us if you're happy for us to share these in the BN and on social media.

We'd love to see you standing next to your sunflower too.

The tallest sunflower measures 9.17 m (30 ft 1 in) and was grown by Hans-Peter Schiffer (Germany) in Karst, Nordrhein Westfalen, Germany, as verified on 28 August 2014 by the Guinness world records team. Not sure we can get to those dizzy heights with our windy climes, but we look forward to your entries.

There will be a prize and certificate for the tallest sunflower. If you need help or more seeds, please contact Julia on **07894516609** or julia@thedailyceilidh.co.uk

POSTCARDS FROM THE ISLANDS: RECORDING LIFE ONE BLIP AT A TIME....



I have always loved photographs, viewing and taking. It has always fascinated me how so much detail/emotion can be captured in that single moment. I started with an old box camera my Grandad gave me and continued through to film - the amount of money spent on developing photos that were over exposed, too dark or just awful photos! But it didn't stop me, especially when the children arrived when the numbers of pictures multiplied, with copies for grandparents and anyone else in the family who showed an interest!

Then along came digital, all you had were the best of photos as the delete button got a lot of use in the early days and then there were mobile phones with cameras built into them - genius.

If I wasn't prolific before, I was now and with the arrival of Facebook I could share pictures with my family, friends and all other Facebook friends!

I have always been a visual person and I love capturing my moments in time - making memories. In 2013 my sister introduced me to Blipfoto, an App which allows you to post one photograph of your day. I loved the idea of being able to create a visual diary providing me with lots of memory moments. Blipfoto is used by people around the world with a wide variety of interests, lifestyles and visual views on life.

My Blip journey started in March 2013 and to date I have posted over 1500 photos, I have not posted everyday during the last 8 years but this year I am making an effort to do just that, I post the photo that means the most to me that day and I very rarely take just one photo so often choosing takes longer than taking the shot!

Due to current restrictions my focus is where I have walked, my commute and my home, so lots of beaches, amazing views, deer and our animals. But as things start to ease out of lockdown I am looking forward to more freedom to travel, including visiting my children in London, so some city views to come.

You can check out some of the amazing daily photos at: www.blibfoto.com.

You don't need an account to browse, or you can download the Blipfoto app.

I have shared a few of my own photos here.



Sue Long
Breaclete



POSTCARDS FROM THE ISLANDS - GUINEA PIG PORTRAITS

When the first lockdown started, I jokingly said to anyone who'd listen, that I'd been training for this isolation my whole life, that I'd been born ready. Fairly true in many respects as despite enjoying chatting to friends and new people alike, I'm actually someone with a fairly low sociability need. I'm quite content with the company of my animals and having a wee chat with the postie or a passing friend every so often. I was also very aware how lucky we were to be in lockdown in a place where we have such freedom outdoors with so few people to share it with. It must have been truly awful to have been in a small flat in a big city.

Even I began to feel a bit restless when the second lockdown hit, however. Not so much due to being contained at home, but more due to increasing anxiety at the entire situation of Covid; furlough worries, financial pressures and the continued effect on people's lives and the economy. It's also very easy to lose some motivation and sense of purpose when the household has lost the routine of folk going out to work most days.

Normally in Spring I would have taken pottery or glass classes at Coll Pottery (fabulous fun, and highly recommend it for when lockdown eases), so with this not being an option I decided it was time to try something new...

In the middle of February I ordered a £2.99 set of children's watercolours and some cheap paint brushes, and I'm so glad I did. I'm having a great time with rather varied results. I won't discuss how bad my landscapes

and beach scenes are (trust me, they're disappointingly horrific!!) but I've really enjoyed trying to paint basic flowers, and love to practice using the brushes correctly. Overall, watercolours haven't been the easiest to use, I've found it's definitely not as straightforward as it looks, so it's quite a challenge but I still enjoy trying! I was also tempted to try my hand at drawing. I started drawing things I'm familiar with, namely a guinea pig and a horse,



and have now added charcoal pencils to my tiny pencil collection and last week tried a human face. I've also tried painting with acrylics twice which I found much easier than watercolours and was very happy with my 2nd attempt using them, when I painted a vase of daisies. I'm therefore leaving acrylics for a while until I feel I'm better at the watercolours and drawing because it would be very tempting to focus on the painting I find easier. The challenge of improving is part of the fun.

Painting and drawing has now become a bit of an obsession and I seem to be permanently finding paint in my hair and

under my fingernails....genuinely makes a nice change to horse poop and hay! I'm finding I sit down for a quick practice session and I'm still there 5 hours later. Most days I'll happily practice or just doodle for an hour at least.

So I'm not sure what all this says about lockdown and our attitude to coping with it. It's highly unlikely I'd have tried something so totally new, and self indulgent timewise, without it though. And I really don't think any artists living locally need to fear competition from my "talent" (please refer to the appalling landscapes issue I covered above) and with my "portraits". I doubt the amazingly talented artist Paul Cadden needs to step aside yetI doubt I'll be challenging him for a spot at a fancy London or New York gallery with guinea pig portraits anytime soon (ie. never)! Still, you never know.....can Paul draw a guinea pig? Does New York or London even have an interest in guinea pig portraits? If not, why not!?! All questions for another day!

Best wishes to all on Bernera from my wee corner on Valasay.



Shona Cooksey
Valasay



BERNERA BAKES

My name is Careen, I am married to Murdo who is originally from Bernera and we have a son Donald who is 12 years old. I am from lovely Ness originally. We came to live in Bernera after living in Ness for a few years. When we came to Bernera to live, I did not know anyone. Now I have a bunch of lovely friends, who made me feel very welcome. Bernera has a lot of great community spirit and welcomes everyone.



I have always been interested in cooking and baking. When I was

younger, I went to Lews Castle College for 2 years and studied Catering. I have had various jobs, but I always go back to cooking as I really enjoy it. I was in Bernera Café for a few years and thoroughly enjoyed working there.

The name Bernera Bakes came from an idea I had after speaking to Julia & Nat outside our house when they were delivering the Bernera News last year. We were talking about the contents of Bernera News & I suggested a recipe every month. So thus, Bernera Bakes.

I think it's good to share recipes, so I have decided to make a cookery book and I would love all the people of Bernera to share their favorite recipes, young and old.

My email is **careenkirkibost@gmail.com** if anyone wishes to share their recipes. We will donate half the money to Bernera Community Association.

A few months ago, we decided to do something which involved baking. We had thought about an honesty box shop. So we decided to try it out. We opened a few weeks ago and it is going very well.

We would like to thank family and close friends so much for the help they gave us with the opening of Bernera Bakes. We would especially like to thank Stuart Sutherland at Graphite Signs, Stornoway, for the amazing services making our signs and labels. We also thank everyone for their support.

The Bernera Bakes honesty box shop can be found at the turning to Kirkibost, on the main road through to Breacleite.



Careen MacLennan
Kirkibost

RABBITS: A POEM BY GAVIN POMEROY, HACKLETE, 1992

Rabbits that bed and breakfast
On the lawn
And stop between their courses to chase each other
Round the salient stones;

Who lollop in the softest form
Now counterpoint to tarmac
Crouched round upon the road
Or upright, aerial ears erect,
Sitting on the grass, hands poised
As if for all the world awaiting
The serving of a meal.
Who could think ill of such softies

Huge innocent eyes akimbo
And silly white tails a-bobbing?
They surely must be made for
Our amusement our delight: but oh
Those chopper teeth are wicked
Where the vegetables grow!
That we prize these more
Perhaps they do not know
As they slip beneath the fence
To innocently come and go.

Colin Halliday
Kirkibost



POSTCARDS FROM THE ISLANDS - QUEEN'S CORONATION & MY BIRTH

The recent death and funeral of Prince Phillip (Duke of Edinburgh) reminded me of an unusual connection between the coronation of his wife – the present Queen of the United Kingdom – Queen Elizabeth II – and the birth of myself – Norman MacLeod.

The coronation of the Queen took place, in a lavish ceremony, at Westminster Abbey in London – on 2 June 1953. As with all state ceremonies the event was organised by a select group of men of great wealth & privilege – titled “Queen’s Heralds”. Prominent among those men was Robin de la Lanne Mirrlees. During the ceremony he was pictured, dressed in his ceremonial robes, standing next to the then Prime Minister – Sir Winston Churchill.

The following morning, 3 June 1953, far away in a much more humble environment, at my grandparents house – 9 Kirkibost, Great Bernera – was born myself – Norman MacLeod.

Many years later, in the early 1960s, Robin de la Lanne Mirrlees would buy the “Bernera Estate” – and in the early 1970s, in very sad circumstances for our family, Robin de la Lanne Mirrlees would buy our family’s humble former home at 9 Kirkibost – which he came to live in c. 1983.



Our family had little contact with the self-styled “Count” Robin de la Lanne Mirrlees until my late brother – Donald Ian MacLeod – contacted him – which resulted in my brother producing a short TV documentary about him in 1994. The first time I met the “Count” myself was in the year 2000 when I stopped at 9 Kirkibost with relatives – he spotted us and invited us in. There were photos on the wall of the Queen’s coronation.

The co-incidence of the contrasting events of 2/3 June 1953 came back to me – and how I was now here at 9 Kirkibost in the presence of Robin de la Lanne Mirrlees – who had taken such a prominent role in the coronation of the Queen – far away in a very different environment around the same time as I was born here in these humble surrounds.



Norman MacLeod
Leurbost

GENERAL KNOWLEDGE QUIZ

1. Animal with the thickest fur
2. Aurora Borealis southern counterpart
3. The Land of Ice and fire
4. The Ponds volcanic line
5. Who sold Alaska to the USA
6. When is the summer solstice down under
7. Norse equivalent of heaven
8. Best duvets are stuffed with
9. Steam train on Mallaig Line called
10. Titanic’s sister ship was called
11. Located between Orkney and Shetland
12. Manmade water way using Lock Ness
13. Helps you work rest and play
14. Largest rocky planet in the solar system
15. Norse god of mischief
16. 1970’s fishing dispute called the
17. Youngest ever US President
18. Bear who likes marmalade sandwiches
19. Islands where Freddy Mercury was born
20. Old lady an apple is named after
21. Leather clad Jim Morrison known as the
22. Year Pompeii covered in ash was
23. Author of the Odyssey
24. Saul was converted on the road to
25. The dame who was M
26. Royal author of ‘The Old Man of Lochnagar’
27. British city famous for its cutlery
28. Royal Navies largest active ship
29. Fought at Brighton on 1960’s bank holidays
30. Standard of a Roman Legion

POSTCARDS FROM THE ISLANDS - TREES

I am not a gardener, I'm a tree grower. I have been growing trees from an early age being lucky enough to grow up in a huge garden full of trees. My first big shock came from moving from an mature village to a new, Newtown. Houses built along side each other with garden separation being a wire fence. I was 15 and this is where I started planting trees. I can get very boring about trees and once I totally bored a whole Christmas dinner party talking about trees. I didn't get a return invitation.

When we came here our croft was a bareland croft, not a jot of trees, just rock, bog and bog plants, but I love these too. The Marsh Orchid with its spotted leaves white into deep purple, the delicate pink Cuckoo flower, the welcome brightness of the Marsh Marigold, the brilliant tiny prolific Tormentil, its leaves a fiery red in autumn. The lovely deep blue of the marsh violet, tiny but perfect, the yellow Bog Asphodel and thousands of other tiny flowers.

But I digress, When we came here a friend said to me, "you won't last long here with no trees" and he was probably right. So my good friends at number 5a gave me hundreds of willow cuttings and this is how I started. (Now I can do the same for others starting brand new gardens.) However, I had a plan. I wanted a garden to look like a forest glade. I wanted to look out of my bedroom window each morning to visit a forest glade, with birds, bees, and butterflies.

Outside my window is a huge rock which underlies all of my garden. I like it. So it stays. But

this means a big area without soil. So I planted four Fuchsia bushes around what might be the base. I call this my ring of fire. Within this I have planted red, pink and purple Hebes, plus willows and a Pampus grass. This constitutes my first glade. I next constructed a natural pond lined with rock and peat, it is a natural sump. When I drained this area, all drains lead to the pond. I have fish, frogs, water



skaters, beetles and billions of tadpoles. This has become my second glade area and is still a work in progress. No fancy paths or gravel edges, just a forest pond.

I aim to have four glades and am working on two willow tunnels to separate these and make little hide outs for a quiet doze out of sight on a garden bench out of the wind. This pond glade is sheltered on all sides by trees.

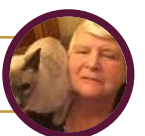
The largest glade will be the one you can see from the road, this is my transient glade, the one you can sit in the sun and talk to passers by, the one which will have pots of bright coloured annuals, and odd looking shrubs

in it, the one I will constantly be walking through to the other hidden ones I have five benches in my garden so I can sit down whenever I want. I paint them green so they don't stand out. Though the starlings like to perch on them unfortunately so I am constantly hosing them down.

When we first moved here to build a house in our sixties, it took all our money and all our courage and the garden I knew would be the work of the last years of my life. So it has to work for me and not be too much digging and weeding. The years have flown past and I am now glad, 17 years later, I made this a garden for an elderly person to sit in the sun and listen to the birds, or read a book and drink a nice glass of wine. It is still a work in progress with more bee loving plants to find a space, two willow tunnels to grow and be strong enough for climbing roses to grow around them. I always have something to look forward to doing should the weather allow me.



Penny Spinks
Hackleto



ALPACAS

Bu chóir dhomh a sgríobhadh mu caoraich oir dh'fhás mi suas nam measg agus bha am fang mu choinneimh an taighe, ach thagh mi cus-pair eile "Alpacas". Feumaidh mi a rádh ge-tá nach eil móran fiosrachaidh agam mun deidhinn.

Nuair a bha mi óg cha chuala mi riamh am facal "Alpaca", ach bha mi fortanach a dh' fhaicinn llamas a tha cáirdeach dhaibh, nuair a ghabh na sgoilearan de'n bun-sgoil cuairt dhan sutha ann an Dún Eideann.

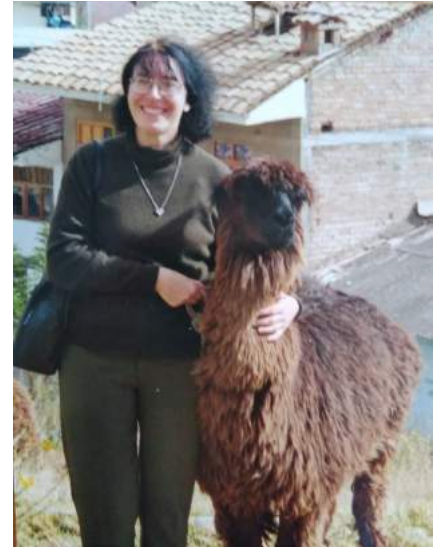
Ged a tha alpacas nádarrach do Aimeireaga a Deas, gheibh sibh iad anns a h-uile áite san t-saoghal a-nis, anns na h-Eileanan Siar cuideachd. 'S e beathaíchean cáirdeil a th'annta agus tha a'cloimh aca bréagha.

Shíubhail sinn gu Pearu agus bha sinn a'fuireach ann an Trujillo, baile mór san ceann a tuath na dúthcha. Aon latha bha féill a' chruidh ann agus b'ann an sin a chunnaic mi alpacas airson a' chiad turas.

Gidheadh bha cuairt gu na beanntan eadhon na b' fheárr. Tha na daoine an sin bochd ach glé dhícheallach agus tha dhá neo trí alpacas aig gach teaghlach. Thachair sinn ri cailleach a bha a' sníomh air beulaibh an taighe agus ri a taobh bha Susanna, alpaca donn, álainn. Thog sinn dealbhan mar as abhaist.

Linntean air ais bha na Mochicas a' fuireach san sgíre sin agus bha iad fíor eólach air figheadaireachd agus créadhadaireachd. Chunnaic mi obair - láimhe aca ann an taigh-tasgaídh: soithichean créadha dearga is odhar (nan dathan sonraichte) agus bha tórr ann le dealbhan de alpacas agus cuíd eile air cruth dhíubh.

Bha alpacas feumail is pailt aig an ám sin agus tha iad cudromach fhathast.



Linne Macleod
Dun Innes



BERNERA BAKES... PEANUT BUTTER CARAMEL CHOCOLATE CAKE

This delicious cake was first made for me by my husband Murdo for our anniversary. Hope you enjoy it as much as we did.

Cake ingredients:

150ml sunflower oil
150ml yoghurt
5 tbsp marmalade
175g dark muscovado sugar
3 eggs
225g self raising white flour
2 tbsp cocoa powder
1 tsp Bicarbonate of Soda

Buttercream:

140g softened butter (unsalted)
280g of icing sugar
3 tbsp peanut butter (smooth)
25ml milk

For the decoration:

397g of caramel (dulce de leche)
4 chocolates (Snickers bar)
100g popcorn (Caramel)

Method:

1. Pre-heat the oven to 170°C (150°C - fan, gas mark 3) grease and line two 8" round cake tins.
2. Beat together the oil, yoghurt, marmalade, sugar and eggs in a large bowl. Sift together the dry ingredients and beat into the cake mixture.
3. Spoon into the prepared tins and bake for 30 minutes.
4. Cool in the tins for 10 minutes then turn out onto a wire rack.
5. Beat together the icing sugar, butter, peanut butter and milk until smooth and creamy.
6. Spread part of the caramel on to the one of the chocolate sponges then top with some of the buttercream. Place the other

sponge on top and then spread the remaining buttercream over the top of the cake.

7. Cut the Snickers bars into chunks and decorate the top of the cake with them and the popcorn.

8. Drizzle the remaining caramel over the top of the cake.



Careen MacLennan
Kirkibost



WELL DONE

'A week is a long time in politics', is quote attributed to a former Prime Minister of the United Kingdom, Harold Wilson.

His words reflected the reality of how in his own experience political things can change rapidly. For good or ill.

In this anniversary edition of the Bernera News we can perhaps elongate the time quoted and say, 'A year is a long time in the middle of a pandemic. A term we were unfamiliar with just over a year ago. Yet, one that describes the period of unprecedented change and challenge through which we have travelled. For some of us, a time of great challenge. For others, a time of great opportunity and blessing.

One such blessing has been the great creation and management of our very own 'Digital Social Media Newspaper' – the 'Bernera News'. Professionally and ably prepared each month under the editorial team of Nat, Sam, Virginia and Julia. What began as a 4-page special has morphed into an 8-page digest of interesting and inspiring articles, biographies and features along with public notices.

Careen MacLennan, feeds us delicious and clearly detailed recipes ensuring that as we follow the instructions a delicious treat shall await us at the conclusion of our labours. Colin Halliday taxes our intellects as we puzzle over our answers. In the last issue, Katie Booth and Joanna George, provided us with an insight into their interesting, edifying, and varied life stories. Not forgetting, Sam Millns' gardening corner that inspires us to demonstrate our 'green fingers'. Albeit some peoples' fingers are greener than others! And of course, Linne MacLeod provides us with her interesting anecdotes in Gaelic.

Such a team working together with a common vision unitedly, is heart-warming and results in what the economists call the 'multiplier effect'. Simply, due to the unity and commitment of the individual the outcome is greater than the sum of the individual parts added together. So, it is with the 'Bernera News'. It is more than just information giving, and notice disseminating it forms community. Our community, and adds richly to it. So, thank you Nat, Sam, Virginia, Julia et al.

Another, God Himself, is community and he is forming a new community to His glory in Jesus. All we require to do is respond yes to His invitation to come to Him:

'Come to Me, all you who labor and are heavy laden, and I will give you rest', **Matthew 11:28**

Rev Hugh Maurice Stewart
Uig & Bernera



BERNERA BUY, SELL, SWAP

Free to a good home:

2 lovely, round, oak effect side tables with 2 levels, in excellent condition.

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